



INDIAN COUNCIL FOR CULTURAL RELATIONS
AZAD BHAVAN, IP ESTATE, NEW DELHI-110002

(SCHOLARSHIP DIVISION)

GUIDELINES FOR ZONAL/SUB ZONAL OFFICES OF ICCR

(A) Standard Operating Procedure to be followed by Zonal/Sub Zonal Offices on arrival of international students under ICCR sponsored scholarship schemes:-

On Arrival

- (i) On receipt of travel plans of the selected students, the RO is to make necessary arrangements for receiving the student from the airport/railway station/ bus stand. If ISA is providing this facility, RO shall liaise with ISA.
- (ii) On arrival, a welcome kit shall be handed over. The kit should contain addresses, email, mobile no. of **Zonal/Sub Zonal Office**, ISA, FRRO, city guide booklet, financial norms of ICCR sponsored Scholarship Scheme in which student is enrolled, Bank Account opening information and any other relevant information (such as medical insurance in India) as deemed appropriate by Zonal/Sub Zonal office..
- (iii) Facilitate student in completion of admission formalities.
- (iv) To help student in registering with Foreign Regional Registration Office within a period of 14 days.
- (v) Immediately on their arrival students should to be given bank account opening form and a letter from ZO/SZO/University concerned recommending immediate opening of bank account at the nearest branch of State Bank of India.

Scholarship Dues

- (i) **Immediately upon arrival in India (or within a maximum period of 7 days of arrival) 3 months advance stipend should be released to the student and before releasing the same, it may kindly be ensured that the student has/had uploaded his/her travel details for travel to India on A2A Portal. No cash payment shall be made to any of the newly arriving students.**
- (ii) Advise the students to submit the Joining Report (JR) and the tuition fee claim as per prescribed proforma within one month of their joining the University/Institute. While filling up the JR, student may be advised to fill the details related to date of birth, nationality, course, college details, registration number etc with utmost care. **Further payment should be released to students only after receiving the joining reports from the students/Institutions.**
- (iii) Maintain and update database of all the students in the format prescribed by Hqrs. It is advisable to separately maintain list of new students.
- (iv) Duly filled-in Joining Report and tuition claim should be sent to ICCR Headquarter along-with forwarding letter seeking approval of tuition fee claimed by the University/institute concerned. The same should also be uploaded on A2A Portal.

Orientation Programme

ZO's/SZO's should organize Orientation Programme in collaboration with Universities/ Institutes for newly arriving students within one month of their arrival. Cultural immersion programme should also be organized by RO in due course. Proposals for such programmes to be submitted separately for seeking approval of Hqrs.

Whatsapp Group

ZO's/SZO's are advised to form a What's-app/similar group of students to remain in touch on a regular basis. RO shall also visit college/institute/ISA regularly to meet students and ISA.

Academic Progress

Regional Office to monitor the Academic Progress of the students studying in the area of their jurisdiction and to ensure uploading of arrival, academic and financial details on A2A Portal.

Procedures to be followed at the time of completion of course

- (i) RO should ensure that student should fill-up the Alumni Form available on A2A Portal before leaving India. This will help Alumni to remain in touch with ICCR for future ICCR activities as well as be helpful in future if their children apply for ICCR scholarship etc.
- (ii) RO should instruct the student to leave for his/her country immediately after the completion of the course/declaration of online consolidated results of all the semesters/final year. Under normal circumstances, the time gap between completion of course/declaration of consolidated results of all semesters/final year and final departure should not exceed 3 weeks time.
- (iii) It should be ensured that Bank Account is closed before student leaves India after completion of his/her studies. This will ensure security from misuse of the dormant bank account.

Norms for Ph.D Students

Ph.D – 36 to 66 Months (After 3 years, RO's should obtain recommendation letter for the duration required for completion of his/her course including viva-voice by his/her Guide/Supervisor).

Change of Subject

ROs may allow the students to change the course subject to the following conditions:-

- (i) Course may be changed from Higher to Lower Level
- (ii) University has no objection to change the course
- (iii) No additional financial implications on ICCR.

(B) Revised Guidelines for Payment of Stipend/House Rent /ACA/Thesis charges etc.

The guidelines with respect to payment of stipend, House Rent Allowance (House Rent), Annual Contingent Allowance (ACA) and other admissible allowance in respect of ICCR sponsored international students stand modified as under:-

- (i) Payment of stipend & House Rent as per prescribed rates may be released together to all students staying outside the hostel. No rent agreement/ Rent receipt is required. However, for records address proof from each of the student should be obtained.
- (ii) In case of students staying in hostels, their hostel rent (excluding electricity and laundry charges etc) may be released to the Institute on receipt of demand from the institute. If hostel fee is paid by the students, ROs may reimburse the hostel rent to student as per norms.
- (iii) In cases where it is mandatory for the students to stay in hostel and the hostel charges are more than the prescribed House Rent Allowance, one time approval of the Competent Authority for payment of House Rent at higher rate may be obtained. The request should be supported with the letter from the concerned University.
- (iv) Payment of CA/ACA as per the prescribed rates may be released at the beginning of the academic year along with stipend and House Rent.
- (v) ***ROs may release one time thesis/dissertation grant to the students (as per prescribed norms) only after student submits Project/Thesis completion certificate obtained from his/her supervisor/Guide.***
- (vi) Students under AYUSH Scholarship Scheme will continue to be governed by terms and conditions of Ministry of Ayush.
- (vii) All the above payments shall be made through PFMS. No cash payments are admissible.
- (viii) ROs may ensure that hostel dues are settled by students before their departure or discontinuation of the Scholarship.
- (ix) ***Examination fee paid by the student to clear his/her backlog will not be reimbursed by ICCR.***

(C) Revised guidelines for Medical Insurance for foreign students studying in India under ICCR Scholarship Schemes

- (i) As per the latest ICCR guidelines, Medical Insurance is compulsory for the students at their cost. Students may buy medical insurance in their country before departure or on their arrival in India. It is up to the students to select the insurance package.
- (ii) ***ROs should ensure that the student has procured Medical Insurance Policy for a value of INR. 5.00 Lakhs before release of Advance Stipend to the students.***

(D) Revised guidelines with respect to deduction of stipend of ICCR sponsored international students for Ex-India period

Guidelines on payment of stipend to ICCR sponsored international students prescribe that students who travel abroad during the academic year are not entitled to stipend for the period they remain out of India. The guidelines have been reviewed and now stand amended to the extent indicated below:

- (i) The practice of deduction of stipend for the duration students remain out of India has been dispensed with.
- (ii) To ensure the valid enrolment of students, in addition to the submission of Joining Report (JR) in the beginning of the academic year, half-yearly certificate to be issued by the competent authority of the University/Institute confirming continuation of studies by the student may be obtained by Regional Offices.
- (iii) Students under AYUSH Scholarship Scheme will continue to be governed by terms & conditions of Ministry of AYUSH.
- (iv) Any of the norms inconsistent with the above stands amended to that extent.
- (v) These guidelines comes into effect from the date of issue.

(E) Guidelines for revival/extension of scholarship in r/o of students whose scholarship had been ceased as they had failed to clear their examination (who joined before 2021-22)

1. The Competent Authority has decided that decision of revival/extension of Scholarship in r/o existing students should be taken up by RO's at their own level without referring to Headquarters on the basis of following course duration:-
 - (i) Undergraduate – 36 Months (For students other than Afghanistan)
 - (ii) Undergraduate Engineering courses – 48 Months
 - (iii) Post-Graduate – 24 Months
 - (iv) Ph.D – 36 to 66 Months (After 3 years, ROs should obtain recommendation letter for the duration required for completion of his/her course including viva voice by his/her Guide/Supervisor.
 - (v) Maximum one-year (6 to 12 Months) extension is admissible only for final year Afghan Students of UG/PG courses.
 - (vi) In addition to the above, the students may be released Scholarship till the declaration of their consolidated results of all the semesters/final year plus 21 days for preparation of his/her departure (on production of final departure ticket from India).
 - (vii) **Headquarters may invariably be kept informed of extension/revival of scholarship of individual student. The portal may also be updated accordingly**
2. In extraordinary circumstances where student has been suspended by the college/University and has been found to be involved in illegal activities, only then the advise of Headquarters should be sought.
3. While releasing scholarship to the students, whose scholarship has been revived, it may be ensured that they have been promoted to next class.
4. **Age limit for students under various courses is as under:-**
PhD – 50 Years maximum
UG/PG – 18- 40 Years

(F) Revised guidelines for revival/extension of scholarship (for new students joining in 2021-22 and onwards)

ICCR has discontinued the provision of extension of Scholarship in r/o any new student except from Afghanistan who would be joining in Academic Year 2021-22 and onwards. There is no change for the existing students.

(G) Guidelines for Scholarship Schemes (other than Afghan Students) for new students joining in Academic Year 2021-22 and onwards

In case a new student fails in first year, his/her ICCR Scholarship would be suspended for one -year and he/she would have to self-finance his/her studies. Scholarship may be revived from next year (at the end of 2nd year) provided student clears the first year. In case student fails second time, his/her Scholarship will stand terminated and he/she would have the option to complete his/her course as a self finance student. In any case, scholarship would not be given for more than the prescribed length of course. Example is given here under:

A new student who joins in July 2021 and onwards:-

- (i) Upon declaration of results :
 - a) If a student is promoted to the next class, his/her scholarship will continue.
 - b) If student fails, and is not promoted to the next class, his/her scholarship will be suspended and can be revived once he/she clears the 1st year (provided he/she clears the exam at the end of 2nd year).
 - c) If the student fails again, the scholarship will stand terminated with no recourse for revival.
 - d) Scholarship will stand terminated if student fails in 2nd year/any subsequent year and is not promoted in the next class/stage.
 - e) Student whose Scholarship is terminated will not be eligible for return air ticket (if the scheme allows air ticket).
 - f) The Council will not extend the scholarship period if student is detained/ barred from appearing in the exam due to shortage of attendance or malpractice.

Guidelines for Afghan Scholarship Schemes:-

- (i) In case a new student fails and is not promoted to next class in first year, his/her Scholarship may be extended by one year. If the student fails again, and is not promoted to next class, he/she would need to self finance his/her studies till he/she clears 1st year. Scholarship may be revived from next year (at the end of 2nd year) provided student clears the first year. In case student fails more than twice, his/her scholarship will stand terminated and he/she would have to complete his/her course as a self finance student. No extension (i.e. scholarship for additional year) be given after completion of 1st Year. In any case scholarship would not be given for more than the prescribed length of course (plus one year extension).
- (ii) The Council will not extend the scholarship period if student is detained/barred from appearing in the exam due to shortage of attendance or malpractice.
